

0
P
Y
AMERICAN JEWISH CONGRESS
330 West 42nd Street - New York City

Dr. Wise's personal address
to which replies should be
sent is: 40 West 68th Street,
New York City

July 23, 1943

The President
The White House
Washington, D. C.

Dear Chief:

It gave me deep satisfaction to find while with you yesterday that out of the depth of your understanding sympathy with Hitler's victims you welcome the proposal which is now before the State and Treasury Departments to permit funds to be forwarded to Switzerland by Jewish organizations of our country. These funds are, of course, to be held in escrow by our Government representatives or such people as they may designate, and would not be handed over to officials (as may survive) of the satellite powers until after the war. These officials, with whom the arrangements will be undertaken, will create such conditions within the Hitler territories as shall enable many Jews in those countries to survive, to escape deportation and ultimately to come out of those countries, continued residence in which would mean torture and death. The whole arrangement is to provide especially for the saving of many little children. We feel that these funds may make possible the salvation of thousands of otherwise doomed beings, especially in Roumania, Slovakia and France, without, I repeat, one penny falling into the hands of enemy representatives for the duration.

I am happier than I can say to think that this proposal, which deals in a feasible and concrete way with an unspeakable situation, commends itself to you, and that you will be good enough to discuss it with the Secretary of the Treasury, whose subordinates are dealing with the problem.

I cannot make clear enough what it would mean to us, and indeed to all civilized people, if you once again, and for the last time, uttered a solemn warning to the representatives of the Nazi regimes in the Hitler conquered territories with respect to the crimes committed against civilians, especially Jews marked out, as you know,